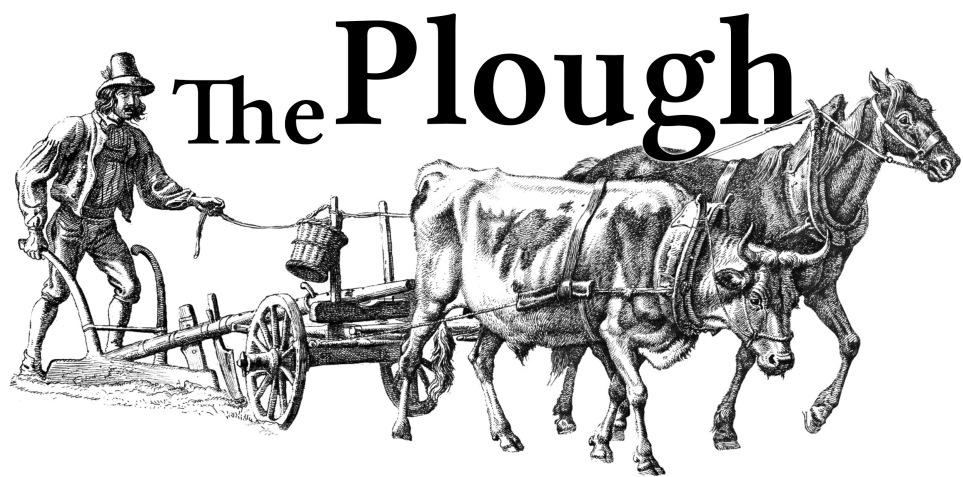




NEMO MITTENS MANUM SUAM AD ARATRUM, ET RESPICIENS RETRO, APTUS EST REGNO DEI
NO MAN PUTTING HIS HAND TO THE PLOUGH, AND LOOKING BACK, IS FIT FOR THE KINGDOM OF GOD

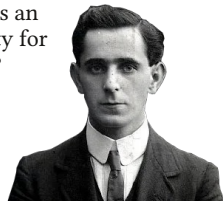
Featuring

Éirí Amach na Cásca: Easter 1916

Cálaeb G. O'Neill

What lessons can Catholics learn from the Easter Rising? Was it a doomed coup attempt all for a masonic-republic? Or a just cause which Catholic men saw as an opportunity for statehood?

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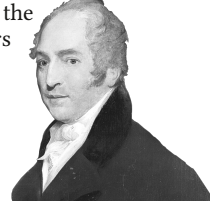


The Work of a Christian Father

Fr W. Cramer SJ

The role of the father of a family today has been relegated—at best—to one of a figure-head; present in theory but absent in practice. Fr Cramer reminds us of the duty of fathers to use their authority.

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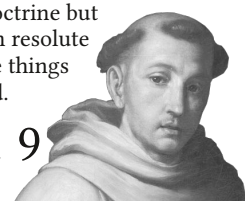
Issue May 2026

In Praise of the New Knighthood

St Bernard

This great Doctor of the Church sanctions violence as a remedy for outrages against justice and against the honour of God. May laymen today not fear this doctrine but remain resolute for the things of God.

pg. 9



Consumer Co-operatives

The Intermediary Institution of Choice Today

Fr Edgar Schmiedeler OSB

Catholics of former times understood well the power of intermediary institutions that were controlled locally. Today, without these intermediate institutions, the public sphere is dominated exclusively by the state. The state, having apostatized and been corrupted for the synagogue of satan, serves as the means for imposing anti-Christendom. Catholics then, need to build institutions which operate in the public sphere but which are not tainted by the hand of the state. By this means, Catholic layfolk will be doing their part to rebuild Christendom in their homelands. Fr Schmiedeler composed this pamphlet in 1937 to encourage Catholics to take responsibility for building these economic institutions of co-operation, better known as co-ops.

One of the most serious evils in our economic system today is excessive profit-taking. One of the most effective means of combating this evil is to be found in the organization of consumers' cooperatives. Because of their indubitable power for remedying this evil, and because of other unquestioned values which flow from them, these cooperatives are deserving of most careful study and attention.

It should not be surprising to find au-

thoritative pronouncements of Catholic churchmen on so useful and practical a remedy for our economic and social ills. Perhaps the most general and all-embracing among such pronouncements is the following, taken from The Bishops' Program of Social Reconstruction (1919):

"More important and more effective than any government regulation of prices would be the establishment of cooperative stores. The enormous toll taken from industry by the various classes of middlemen is now fully realized. The astonishing difference between the price received by the producer and that paid by the consumer has become a scandal of our industrial system. The obvious and direct means of reducing this discrepancy and abolishing unnecessary middlemen is the operation of retail and wholesale mercantile concerns under the ownership and management of the consumers. This is no Utopian scheme. It has been successfully carried out in England and Scotland through the Rochdale system. Very few serious efforts of this kind have been made in this country because our people have not felt the need of these co-operative enterprises as keenly as the European working classes, and because we have been too impatient and too individualistic to make the necessary

sacrifices and to be content with moderate benefits and gradual progress. Nevertheless, our superior energy, initiative and commercial capacity will enable us, once we set about the task earnestly, even to surpass what has been done in England and Scotland.

"In addition to reducing the cost of living, the co-operative stores would train our working people and consumers generally in habits of saving, in careful expenditure, in business methods, and in the capacity for cooperation. When the working classes have learned to make the sacrifices and to exercise the patience required by the ownership and operation of cooperative stores, they will be equipped to undertake a great variety of tasks and projects which benefit the community immediately and all its constituent members ultimately. They will then realize the folly of excessive selfishness and senseless individualism. Until they have acquired this knowledge, training and capacity, desirable extensions of governmental action in industry will not be attended by a normal amount of success. No machinery of government can operate automatically, and no official and bureaucratic administration of such machinery can ever be a substitute for intelligent interest and cooperation by the individuals of the community."

"In addition to reducing the cost of living, the cooperative stores would train our working people and consumers generally in habits of saving, in careful expenditure, in business methods, and in the capacity for cooperation"

It would be a simple matter to add other statements favorable to cooperatives from a veritable array of Catholic authorities. A few more will be given toward the end of this booklet. For the present we will turn our attention instead to considerations such as the meaning and classification of cooperatives, and extent of their growth, the principles underlying them, and their peculiar economic and social values.

Meaning and Classification of Cooperatives

It is not an altogether simple matter to define a cooperative. To be sure, it is easy to say that "to cooperate means to work together." But such a definition is too simple. It does not really show the distinctive features of what has come to be known today as cooperative enterprise.

Stating that, technically cooperation has been defined as "that joint economic action which seeks to obtain for a relatively weak group, all or part of the profit and interest which in the ordinary capitalist enterprise are taken by a small and different group," Rev. F. Basenach, S.J., Loyola College, Madras, British India, goes on to say that characteristic of the cooperative system is the issue of profits. "In the cooperative form of organization," he says, "the profits go to the members, either under their aspect of cooperative producers who have pooled their individual capital and labor, or without regard to the capital invested, it goes to the members according to the products they have used. The first form is known as Producers' Cooperation; the second, as Consumers' Cooperation." And he adds, referring to the consumer, that "the aims of cooperation are undeniably revolutionary in this sense that they tend to undermine the foundations of the present capitalistic system. The object is to restore all the profits, which capital has long regarded as its due, to the consumers; hence



Rhyl's co-op store, Northern Wales, September 1912. Stores like these served the co-op members, whom could expect an annual dividend on account of their being members, and therefore, part-owners in the enterprise.

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Consumer Co-operatives Cont.

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the first promise of cooperation is to reduce the burden placed on the consumer by capital."

In the June 1936 issue of *The Catholic World* we gave the following generic definition of cooperation: "A cooperative society or organization is a group of people who band themselves together to produce something, to sell something, to buy something for themselves, or to pool their financial resources for credit or loan purposes."

When a group of individuals band themselves together to produce something we have what is known as a producers' cooperative. In this country [The United States] there are but very few of these cooperatives. When a group bands together for the purpose of selling something, the result is a marketing cooperative. This type of co-op is relatively common among American farmers. When a group of individuals unite to pool their resources for loan purposes, the result is a credit cooperative. Finally, if a number of people unite for buying or purchasing purposes, we have what is known as a consumers' cooperative. It is this type that we are chiefly interested in here.

Perhaps the following definition of "consumption" taken from a recent issue of the *Scholastic* will show a bit more specifically what is implied by the term "consumers' cooperative": "Consumption is the use of any goods or services for the satisfaction of human needs. It is not only the eating of food or the burning of coal that we can see disappear before our eyes, but it is the wearing of clothes, living in houses, running machines, going to school, getting our hair cut, calling in the doctor, traveling in an automobile, going to the movies, turning on the radio, mailing a letter, or doing anything whatever that calls for the work of others or uses up ever so slowly, the accumulated 'capital goods' of the human race. Every one of us, from birth to the cemetery, is a consumer one hundred percent of the time. We may or may not be producers, for, like the bees, we have

queens, workers, and drones; but we are all of us consumers. And just because this is true, every one has an interest, whether he knows it or not, in what he buys and uses and in how it is handed out to him."

It is well to observe that not infrequently one finds several types of cooperatives combined in one and the same group. Thus, the members of the Gary (Negro) consumers' cooperative have also organized a credit union. To cite another example, the noted marketing cooperative, Land O'Lakes Creameries in the Northwest, does much purchasing of feed, machinery, and the like, for its members. In this latter capacity it is a consumers' rather than a marketing cooperative.

How Co-ops Develop

Not all cooperatives follow the same line of development. But not infrequently they originate and develop in some such way as the following: A group of friends or neighbors get together to discuss the possibility of making some of their ordinary purchases together. They form what might be called a buying club. The most common article of consumption is selected and the organization is built around it. Other services, close to the people as consumers, are gradually added. As the membership grows, mass purchasing power leads to wholesale buying on a constantly increasing scale.

When several such groups in a certain territory have carried on successfully for a while, they may decide to join together in a federation of cooperatives to perform larger functions. They may even develop their own wholesale business. In turn, several such wholesaling concerns may move on to importing, to warehousing, and to manufacturing. The final step comes when the control of raw materials—plantations, fields, forests, or other original source of supply—is added. Certain European countries have for some time extended their business through the stages of economic organization from the ownership of raw material sources to the final retailing of products to the consumer.

As a rule development is gradual. Ad-

vancement is only made as fast as experience and competence in administrative ability admit. Nor do all cooperatives develop to the full stature spoken of in the foregoing. There is almost untold variety. Some are, and remain, no more than little neighborhood groups; others extend over large regions. Some make only occasional purchases; others are a continuing or full-time business, handling a considerable variety of goods. Some provide a delivery service for their members; others do not. It is not uncommon, for example, for a group of farmers to buy a carload of some commodity—let us say, coal or fertilizer, or perhaps salt for their live stock—and then have the individual farmers come to a railroad siding and pick up their portion of the produce. Naturally, such a system eliminates the expense of both warehousing and delivery service.

To state that development is gradual is not necessarily to say that it is slow. In many instances growth is quite rapid. A few simple instances will show this. There is, for example, the consumers' cooperative at Flint, Michigan. Organized in 1933, by eight families, and having an initial capital of \$22, it had grown by the end of 1935 to 260 families and was doing a business of \$3,000 a month.

Another example is that of the so-called Consumers' Cooperative Services, organized as a buying club in Chicago by nine persons in 1932. It has since grown into a very successful co-op, doing a monthly business of \$3,500.

The Negro cooperative at Gary, begun under most unfavorable circumstances by a small group in 1932, had by 1935 grown to 371 members, employed seven people, and made sales totaling \$34,055.26 for that year. The goal for 1936 was a \$50,000 business, and future plans call for branch stores at Gary, East Chicago, and Indiana Harbor, and for a bakery and a dairy.

Kinds of Consumers' Cooperatives

As suggested by the definition of "consumption," there are a great many different kinds of consumers' cooperatives, all of them supplying certain goods or services



Fr. Edgar Schmiedeler OSB 1892–1963

of which the members stand in need. For example, there are cooperative gas and oil stations. There are associations operating retail stores, restaurants, bakeries. There are others carrying on cooperative housing projects. There are cooperative power lines for electrification, cooperative recreation projects, mutual associations for insurance or for telephone service, for medical aid and even for burial service. And by no means does this exhaust the list. New fields are being opened constantly.

A few examples should do more than perhaps anything else to show the diversity of types, and also to indicate some of their functions.

Here is a very simple instance. A pastor organized a cooperative coal purchasing program, requesting all his parishioners to buy their coal together. The current retail price was paid by all. The difference between the wholesale price for the entire quantity bought and the retail price paid by the individual parishioners for their particular shares was sufficient to cover the expense of the entire coal supply for the parish church and school building.

The Survey, in its November 1935 mid-monthly issue, describes in its pages a rather novel cooperative venture, a cooperative hospital located at Elk City, Oklahoma. Some 1,800 families in Elk City

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Indian Youth in the Wild

Self-Control and Manhood

Bishop Tihamer Toth

It is childish to be impressed by a face getting red in response to every word, by the clenched fist, the blustering out threats and fighting. The lack of patience and quarrels are always signs of a weak will.

Yet, why is such behavior so common? Because it is easy, it takes no effort. In impatient squabbles everything happens by itself, like a wagon rolling down hill. By contrast, self-control requires an effort: climbing from the swamp of passions up towards the mountain of victorious will. Real self-control is not the patience of a packhorse, it is not effeminate cowardliness, but strength, courage and endurance. Have you suffered a sad disappointment? Are you bored? Are you angry? Are you discouraged? Make sure that nobody can detect it in your words and behavior. That is self-control. Somebody has been annoying you for a quarter of an hour and you would really like to punch him in the face, but instead you merely touch his arm

gently and say: "Be careful, I could handle you." That is self-control.

Impatience is the sign of weak will. The instincts manifesting themselves in impatience are present in animals also; but it is more fitting that man should put them under the control of deliberation and decision, i.e., under the control of intellect and will. The smaller the child, the more impatient he is; he is obstinate, fumes with rage, screams; of course he cannot yet use his intellect and will, only the animal instincts work in him. But it is quite revolting when a grown-up does the same, thereby giving testimony that he is a slave of his instincts.

I am sure, my son, that you do not want to be the slave of your instincts. So observe yourself frequently: what is most likely to make you lose your temper, what can get you excited, and then start the fight against overhastiness and hotheadedness. This way you uproot a lot of unfair judgment, hasty words, and rash deeds.

It was the custom of some tribes of American Indians that when a boy reached the end of

puberty and was to be solemnly initiated into manhood, prior to the initiation he was sent out into the wilderness for two weeks. He was given a bow and arrows and the strict command: he must not kill, he must not even touch any animal. All the animals, deer and rabbits are running in his sight. The hands of the boy are trembling with excitement. All in vain, he is forbidden to shoot! What is he to do in the wilderness for two weeks? He can eat roots and berries or fast. If he can keep the rules, he will be initiated into manhood. You see, these Indians understand much better than we soft Europeans that self-control is the best preparation for the struggles of life, and the best indication of manhood.

But it is not enough to read about self-control and know about it a lot; you have to put it into practice. Knowledge is the theory of action, but action is practical knowledge. The will must be strengthened in a young age, it must be improved just like the rose is improved by grafting it when it is young. It is too late to do when it is old.

What a sad sight is a weak-willed young man! It takes him an enormous effort to make a decision, to utter a "yes" or a "no." Even worse

is to start doing what he finally decided to do. Principles, independent thinking he has none, not in his last years of high school, not even when he grows up. He always watches what the others do and he does likewise. He is marionette without a will, a baby in long pants.



Young Scotch hunter learning self-control



Consumer Co-operatives Cont.

Continued from Page 2

and the surrounding territory own and control the hospital, and through it get the medical, surgical, and dental care they need. Each family membership entails ownership of at least one \$50 share of stock, which may be paid in installments. This stock provides the capital for the eighty-bed institution. Operating costs and payments to the physicians are met by monthly charges of \$1 or \$2 a family, according to which of two plans a family chooses. In return the family is entitled to medical and surgical care without further costs, except for a few specified charges.

The Oklahoma Board of Medical Examiners has attacked the project as “unethical,” and has urged that the license of Dr. Michael Shadid, founder and director, be revoked. The latter has secured a temporary restraining order. He charges a conspiracy to destroy the hospital, stating that, “because the individuals behind this prosecution feel that if this experiment is allowed to succeed, other cooperative hospitals will be established and their personal income will be reduced, and because of their alarm at the success of the hospital referred to, they have decided to destroy the experiment by revocation of the license of this petitioner.”

There should be little question of the outcome of the legal battle if the members of the cooperative are consulted in the matter.

In Japan such cooperative hospitals are now to be found in considerable numbers. One report states that there are more than sixty of them.

Not dissimilar to co-op hospitals are medical aid cooperatives. These are now found in some numbers in Canadian municipalities. The arrangement calls for a definite annual contribution toward a fund on the part of families of a community. Out of this fund a stated salary is paid a doctor who is considered the group’s physician and is expected to care for the medical needs of all the members.

Dr. James P. Warbasse, President of the Cooperative League, has this to say on the subject: “The cooperative method really begins when a group of 150 to 500 families unite to employ a physician full-time. The number of people necessary and the costs depend upon their ability to pay. In the country, or in a small town, 200 families, representing 800 people, may put in an average of \$20 per family. That is at the rate of \$5 per person. This gives \$4,000 a year. Physicians are entering into this arrangement for salaries varying from \$3,000 to \$7,000. It is best that the annual costs per member be graded according to family income. If a group is divided into three classes of families, one group would pay \$40 a year, one \$20, and one \$10—making an average of \$20. A plan which should be equitable would be to make the average cost \$10 for one individual, \$15 for man and wife, and \$2 for each child or dependent. Thus, in a group of 200 married couples, of 380 children, and of 24 single adults, the income would be \$4,000.”

Co-op Principles

Underlying all these consumer cooperative endeavors are certain very definite principles that must be followed if the enterprises are to be genuine, if they are to prove thoroughly sound and successful. The principles are, in general, those that have become known as the Rochdale principles, that is, those followed by the group of cooperative pioneers at Rochdale, England. A consideration of these should do

not a little to bring out the chief differences between the cooperative and the usual competitive or capitalistic enterprise. It should also help to clarify further the precise meaning as well as the functions of cooperation.

1. First of all there is the question of control of management. Under cooperation there is democratic control. Capital is secured through the sale of shares to members, and every shareholder, no matter how few or how many shares he may have, has a right to one, and only one, vote in the management of the common enterprise. Under capitalism it is different. As organized to day, capitalism practically separates control from ownership. Through such devices as non-voting stock, wide distribution of small numbers of shares which cannot be voted because of distance of travel, and such like, the great majority of share owners are denied an effective voice in the management of the enterprise. Control is exerted by the few. And this control can, and often does, become despotic, autocratic. As the Rev. Charles Aziere, O.S.B., recently stated: “With 200 largest corporations controlling 22 per cent of the total wealth of the country, and owning as much as the other 300,000 odd corporations combined, under such separation of control that the interests of the consumer, the laborer, and the owners themselves are all subservient to the interests of the management group; and where because of the dominant position in the economic field the price structure and credit structure are set by the same interested group, there one finds dominance from the top down through every phase of activity such as would in political science be called despotism, but in economic science is still called capitalism.”

Genuine cooperative principles demand democratic control. They insist on ownership of property again connoting control of the use of property, something which it did from time immemorial, but has not been doing under modern large-scale capitalism.

2. A fixed rate of interest is paid on shares, or on the investment in capital stock, and earnings are distributed to the members in proportion to their patronage. In other words, the members of the cooperative get four, five, or at most, six percent interest on their shares, and then from the funds that are left over after all expenses of conducting the co-op’s business have been taken care of, they receive earnings according to the value of the purchases they have made. For example, a member who spends \$500 a year at a cooperative store, gets five times as much out of the surplus savings as the member who only spends \$100. Under the capitalistic system, it is different. Earnings there go to the owners in proportion to the amount of their investment.

3. In the interests of expediency, sales or services made by the society are charged at competitive prices. Thereby disastrous price wars with competitors are avoided. Any profits that result from the undertaking are simply considered overcharges and, as already indicated, are returned to the patrons of the business. While this is the general rule, there are notable exceptions. Swedish cooperatives, for instance, have openly fought monopolies through the device of price-cutting. They have refused to charge their exorbitant competitive prices.

4. Not all the earnings or savings are distributed. A certain amount is customarily set aside as a reserve fund for protection against possible loss. Very commonly a certain percentage is set aside for education. Every worth-while cooperative

emphasizes educational work or training in cooperation through circulars, pamphlets, lectures, study clubs, and the like. They consider this essential to a soundly progressive cooperative movement. Certain amounts of the surplus savings may be used for still other purposes, such as recreation, art, health, insurance—provided, of course, the members wish it and give their approval.

Values of Cooperatives

There are both economic and social values in cooperation. As the writer has stated elsewhere (The Catholic World, June, 1936), he is convinced that cooperation gives not a little promise of eliminating the more glaring abuses, such as waste and the gouging of the consumer, that characterize our present system. More particularly will this be true as cooperation moves from the consumers’ field back into production. Prices will then tend more and more to be in harmony with actual cost rather than with monopoly manipulation, watered stock, or eagerness for pyramided profits. The cooperative owners or members have every reason to see to it that their business is run efficiently, for each has a stake in it. At the same time they have no reason to bid up prices, for they are both buyers and sellers. Hence, in a cooperative society one would hardly expect to find such a thing as middlemen taking 300 percent on the retail sales of milk products as is done, for instance, in New York. There would be little point to such procedure in a cooperative society.

There is no question that cooperatives can influence prices. There are not a few cases on record in which they have lowered exorbitant prices. One instance that has attracted particular attention is that of a number of cooperative burial associations in Minnesota. In 1930 an organization called the Minnesota Valley Burial Association was formed. Each member of the organization contributed five dollars to be used as the original capital, for a reserve fund, and to help those who could not pay for a funeral. When this cooperative organization began, the cost of a funeral in the state averaged between \$500 and \$700. Shortly afterwards the average price dropped to \$212. This organization found that it could duplicate with \$300 the funeral that previously cost \$780. In 1932 nine cooperative funeral associations in Minnesota buried 231 people at an average cost of \$186 each. This was about half the average rate in other places.

Among the best organized cooperatives in this country are the oil and gas co-ops. These, too, have brought about notable reductions in prices. Cooperative buying of petroleum products has resulted in some instances in reducing the margin between the tank-car price and the tank-wagon price by 7 or 8 cents a gallon. In addition, many cooperative oil associations have made patronage refunds of 10 to 15 percent, and even more.

Sometimes the savings made by cooperatives are obscured by the fact that competitive dealers reduce their prices. It is no secret that there is need for much such reduction of prices in this country. It is a bit strange, for instance, that in London, a city far removed from its wheat supply, the price of bread should be lower than in Omaha, located in the immediate neighborhood of our immense wheat fields.

Referring to the social values of cooperatives, a report of St. Francis Xavier University, a Catholic institution in Nova

“There is need for action. The abuses in our economic system clamor for correction. Consumers’ cooperatives furnish one effective means for correcting them. We should not hesitate to make the most of them.”

Scotia which has done outstanding work in fostering co-ops, has the following to say, among other things: “One of the chief values of the cooperative movement lies in the opportunity it gives the average citizen to function as a conscious agent in shaping his economic life and welfare. He works with others for a common end and mutual good. Day by day he learns that by cooperating with others he serves himself best. He respects leadership because he sees how it must develop. He acquires stature as a citizen in political and economic relations with his fellow man.”

To be given some voice in the direction of affairs is good for the individual. He acquires an added value, a healthy importance, one might say, in his own eyes. He develops a sense of responsibility, of self-respect and of self-reliance, that should prove beneficial both to himself and to society. Cooperation gives to the individual such a voice in affairs. It takes from those who have been economically underprivileged their feeling of helplessness and brings to them a realization that something can be done about it.

Cooperation also inculcates a spirit of self-sacrifice and teamwork. It begets a spirit of neighborly helpfulness, for it is organized on the basis of mutual aid. It offers excellent opportunities for the fulfillment of the commandment, “Bear ye one another’s burdens and so shall ye fulfill the law of Christ.” It provides an environment that encourages the control of such socially harmful tendencies of man as greed, avarice, pride, gluttony, and selfishness.

Before concluding, a caution or two may be in place. There is, first of all, the consideration that a cooperative system will not automatically and inevitably lead to good results. Vigilance is necessary. The unsocial tendencies of man must be effectively held in check. Continued effort is required if a cooperative program is to be kept in harmony with the laws of justice and charity.

A second point is this: Cooperation should not be presented merely as an economic program. The Most Rev. Edwin V. O’Hara gives the following two reasons for this: First, it would “raise extravagant expectations of material gains from this source”; second, it would “tend to becloud the vast social, cultural, and moral benefits of cooperation—benefits which would justify cooperation apart from more material gains.”

Finally, the mistake must not be made of looking upon consumers’ cooperatives as the one cure-all of our economic ills. To work for the extension of a cooperative society, for instance, but at the same time to neglect the development of strong labor organizations, would be no less than foolhardy.

With these cautions in mind, the Catholic may well give serious attention to the formation of consumers’ cooperatives. Indeed, he should do so. There is need for action. The abuses in our economic system clamor for correction. Consumers’ cooperatives furnish one effective means for correcting them. We should not hesitate to make the most of them.

Éirí Amach na Cásca: Easter 1916

What Lessons Might Catholics Learn From The Easter Rising?

Mr Cálaeb G. O'Neill MA

An exclusive for The Plough: our author provides a history of the Easter Rising of 1916 in Ireland, and unpacks some lessons for Catholics today.

Disclaimer: The brevity of this article and the complexity of the 1916 Easter Rising make a full explanation of the Rising and the events surrounding it nigh on impossible for a man of my mean abilities, I have tried my best under present constraints to provide an overview suitable to a varied audience.

Let me carry your Cross for Ireland, Lord!
Let me suffer the pain and shame
I bow my head to their rage and hate,
And I take on myself the blame. Let them do
with my body whate'er they will,
My spirit I offer to You.
That the faithful few who heard her call
May be spared to Roisin Dubh.

— Thomas Ashe

Easter Monday, 1916, over two thousand set out to break 700 years of British rule in Ireland. These men lacked support from the public and from their own clergy; they were poorly armed, poorly trained and they knew there was little prospect of success. Yet, like generations of men before them, they knew they had to take action.

In less than a fortnight, Dublin would be in ruins, eighty-two of their number would be killed, a further sixteen executed, and countless civilians also killed and wounded.

Though their actions were unpopular and condemned, the coming years would see these men recognised not as revolutionaries seeking violence for violence sake, but as heroes and martyrs, devout Catholics who sought only what was best for their nation whilst those around them counselled the same peaceful, constitutional, attempts at change that had failed countless times before.

So why was violent action viewed as a necessity by the men of Easter week?

There is no simple answer. We can point to the centuries of English misrule, of war, pestilence and famine. To religious persecution and the desire of the Catholic Gael to no longer be under the yoke of the Protestant Saxon. To throw off once and for all the likes of Elizabeth I, Nicholas Bagenal, Oliver Cromwell, William of Orange and Charles Trevelyan.

We can also highlight the proud history of Gaelic resistance to foreign incursion.



Pádraig Anraí Mac Piarais (Patrick Pearse) in 1916: a devout Catholic.

From Na Fianna of old, to Brian Boru; from O'Donnell and O'Neill to Confederate Ireland; from the United Irishmen, Young Ireland and the Fenian Brotherhood down to themselves, they were a part of a heroic tradition. Yet, in spite of all this, they did not have popular support.

This lack of popular support can be boiled down to two factors the gilded chains spoken of by Pádraig Pearse and recent political developments which we will touch upon later.

When Pearse spoke of gilded chains, he spoke not of the physical bondage and constraints of the past, but of a far more dangerous bondage, that of comfort. Pearse saw that the people had grown used to the day-to-day comforts provided for by British rule in Ireland. He knew that for most men, gaining comfort at the expense of their Gaelic nationhood and being turned into little more than West Britons, though sad, was more palatable than undergoing the hardship and sacrifices necessary to restore their nation.

This problem of the gilded chains is one familiar to men of every generation, especially to our own. Fortunately for the Irish in 1916, men like Pearse were willing to offer up their own sacrifice to save the soul of Ireland from ruin.

The other reason for a lack of popular support were recent political developments. In the preceding century, Irish Catholics had slowly made progress from persecution under the penal laws to a state of full emancipation.

Charles Stuart Parnell's Irish Parliamentary Party (IPP) had slowly secured for itself a key place in the halls of Westminster and by 1914, the IPP under John Redmond had secured the passage of the third Home Rule Bill which would guarantee Ireland a degree of self-governance.

Although the prospect of Home Rule was met by strong opposition from Unionists to such a degree that the Ulster Volunteer Force (UVF) was formed in 1912 to fight against it if necessary. And, when the Bill was passed in 1914, the British Army in Ireland threatened mutiny rather than enforce the Bill upon the UVF. In response, the nationalists founded the Irish Volunteers to ostensibly 'hold Ireland for the Empire' and help with the implementation of self-government.

Adding to this tension, were the presence of the Irish Citizen Army (ICA), a Socialist paramilitary group under the command of James Connolly and the Hibernian Rifles, a Catholic Paramilitary attached to the Ancient Order of Hibernians. This meant that by 1914, the British administration was forced to keep track of four separate private armies as well as the Irish Republican Brotherhood (IRB).

Fortunately for the British Government, 1914 saw the outbreak of war on the European Continent, allowing them to save face by putting off Home Rule until after the war.

Constitutional nationalists under Parnell committed to support the war effort and pledged the use of the Irish Volunteers in the hopes that this would demonstrate that Ireland was mature enough to face the burden of self-government. This was followed by the UVF also pledging themselves to the war effort.

To men like Padraig Pearse and other members of the IRB, Parnell's actions were anathema and the Irish Volunteers split

over the issue leaving the militant faction with just 15,000 men. Though a devastating setback, the IRB committed themselves to staging an uprising before the end of the European war, holding true to the adage "England's difficulty is Ireland's opportunity."

A war committee formed from a subset of the IRB executive. Their duty was to plan the Rising using the forces available and ensure that they would be suitably armed for the purpose.

Later, the ICA would be coopted into these plans after the Military Council of the IRB realised that Connolly was planning his own rising and risked undermining the Brotherhood's own plans. This co-opting left the Hibernian Rifles (an all Catholic paramilitary branch of the Ancient Order of Hibernians) as the only nationalist paramilitary grouping in the country to not be included in the plans for the rising.

In 1915, veteran Fenian and IRB member Jeremiah O'Donovan Rossa died in America. The IRB elected to have him returned home, his funeral was to be their opportunity to garner public support as, at the time, eulogies were one of the few instances of public speech permitted.

The then little known IRB member, the schoolteacher, poet and gaelic scholar Pádraig Pearse was chosen to give this eulogy. When he enquired as to the degree of caution to be taken with his speech, he was advised to throw caution to the wind. This resulted in one of the most influential political speeches in Irish history which, in its final words has been quoted by men of action in every generation since.

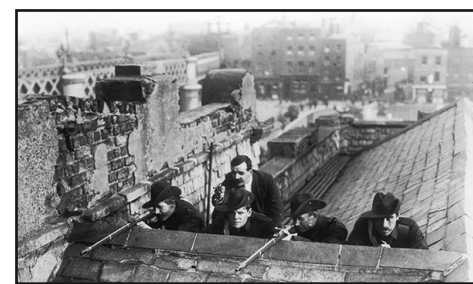
"They think they have purchased half of us, and intimidated the other half. But the fools, the fools, the fools, the fools, they've left us our Fenian dead, and while Ireland holds these graves, Ireland unfree shall never be at peace."

Whilst this was going on, the IRB was also engaging in three important overseas missions. In the United States, the Brotherhood was working with Clan na Gael (effectively the American branch of the IRB) and its head John Devoy to secure funding and arms for the rising. In Germany, with the help of Clan na Gael, the former British diplomat Sir Rodger Casement was working to both secure German arms, support for the rising as well as future recognition of an Irish Republic as well as attempting to raise an Irish Brigade from Irish POWs in German camps.

Most importantly, the IRB had despatched the Papal Count George Noble Plunkett—relative of the martyr Blessed Oliver Plunkett—to secure the Holy Father's blessing for the endeavour. The Pontifical Benediction was obtained from Pope Benedict XV after a two hour meeting between Plunkett and His Holiness. This blessing was crucial for men who were devout Catholics and facing, much like the men of our times, heavy critique from other Catholic men who would label any action as imprudent at best and sinful at worst.

Though many setbacks were experienced, from the failure for German support to materialise to the attempt of Eoin MacNeill (officially Chief of Staff for the Volunteers) to cancel the rising at the last minute, the IRB were able to issue orders

"This problem of the gilded chains is one familiar to men of every generation, especially to our own. Fortunately for the Irish in 1916, men like Pearse were willing to offer up their own sacrifice to save the soul of Ireland from ruin."



Irish rifles upon a rooftop: Dublin 1916.

that the rising would go ahead on Easter Monday, rather than on Easter Sunday as originally planned.

Upon seeing MacNeill's attempt at cancelling the "special manoeuvres" (code for the rising), the Commandant of the Hibernian Rifles realised that a rising was planned and ordered the Rifles to drill the next day. About fifty of the rifles ended up, in the spirit of true Catholic brotherhood, showing up to fight in a rebellion that they had not planned.

At 12 noon various units of the Volunteers and ICA seized key targets across Dublin with the main unit under Pearse capturing the General Post Office (GPO) and with Pearse reading the Proclamation of the Irish Republic from the steps.

The rebels managed to hold Dublin City for an entire week as British troops poured in to suppress the rising. Eventually however, the civilian casualties became too much for the likes of Pearse and the decision was made to surrender.

The involvement of the Hibernian Rifles was not the only case of Catholic manhood choosing to take a part in this momentous episode in Irish history. In fact, there are many cases of men and women volunteering to play their part from women opting to nurse the wounded, to former pupils of Pearse volunteering to face what most realised would be certain death out of loyalty to both their race and to the man who had painstakingly educated them in the love of their God and their country.

Unfortunately, it would take too long to tell the story of every Catholic who chose to undertake this sacrifice against insurmountable odds, so one will have to suffice.

The O'Rahilly, a firm activist for the Gaelic culture and officer in the Irish Volunteers was a man like MacNeill, he strongly discouraged any attempt by the IRB and the Volunteers to stage a rising unless strict conditions were met. However, once he found out that the rising was indeed going to happen, he did not condemn the actions like so many others, nor did he shy away from the action. Rather, He donned his uniform, bade goodbye to his family and reported for duty in the

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Éirí Amach na Cásca: Easter 1916 Cont.

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knowledge that if there were to be a rising, his place was in it. Sadly, but much to his glory, the O’Rahilly lost his life on the penultimate day of the rising in the attempt to personally lead a charge against the British barricades on Moore Street as part of the break-out from the GPO.

As he lay dying, he managed to pen a farewell letter to his wife. The next day, in light of the casualties being inflicted upon the civilian population, Pearse ordered an

unconditional surrender.

Within a week of the surrender, fifteen men had been executed, they were:

Pádraig Pearse, 36, Commandant in the Irish Volunteers, Commander in Chief of the Army of the Irish Republic, Signatory of the Proclamation;

Thomas Clarke, 58, veteran Fenian, Signatory of the Proclamation;

Thomas MacDonagh, 38, Commandant in the Irish Volunteers, Signatory of the Proclamation;

Joseph Plunkett, 28, Commandant in the

Irish Volunteers, Signatory of the Proclamation;

Edward Daly, 25, Commandant in the Irish Volunteers;

Michael O’Hanrahan, 39, Vice-Commandant in the Irish Volunteers;

Willie Pearse, 34, Captain in the Irish Volunteers;

Seán MacBride, 47, Veteran Fenian, Second in Command to MacDonnagh;

Éamonn Ceannt, 34, Commandant in the Irish Volunteers, Signatory of the Proclamation;

Michael Mallin, 41, Second in Command of the Irish Citizen Army;

Seán Heuston, 25, Captain in the Irish Volunteers;

Con Colbert, 27, Captain in the Irish Volunteers, founding member of Na Fianna Éireann;

Thomas Kent, 50, Irish Volunteers;

James Connolly, 47, Commandant in the Irish Citizen Army, Signatory of the Proclamation.

Seán MacDiarmada, 33, Signatory of the Proclamation.

A couple of months later, in August, the diplomat *Sir Rodger Casement*, 51, was stripped of his knighthood, calumniated with the insinuation that he was a sodomite through a series of forged diaries, and, finally, executed as a traitor to the crown. Though the English stripped him of his title, it is an honour restored to him by the Irish people in thanks for the ultimate sacrifice he made.

In the aftermath of the rising, the men who took part were initially reviled by the civilian population. However, the executions and heavy-handed application of martial law by the British quickly turned popular support in favour of the rebels.

The repressive measures taken in the aftermath of the rising also proved a god-send for the military organisation of the Irish people and their preparation for the next stage of their struggle.

Men like MacNeill had once argued

“The involvement of the Hibernian Rifles was not the only case of Catholic manhood choosing to take a part in this momentous episode in Irish history.”

against the likes of Pearse in the belief that there was no reasonable prospect of success and hence no moral ground upon which to stage the rising. The men of Easter week however, had proven in hindsight that their success was not in the winning of any direct military objective, but in the continued efficacy of their sacrifice to redeem their nation. Popular support was not to be won with talk, but with action.

Though it is a shame that more cannot be said about these and other great men who took part in the Easter Rising, this brief overview should be enough for any man to see that these were men of duty, they were Catholic men of a kind seldom seen in modern times.

The men spanned from boys in the flower of youth to men in their sunset years. They serve as a reminder to all Catholic men of all ages and all generations, that our duties lie not only in the sphere of religion, but also call us forth to serve our nations, whether in a humble manner or in great service. Seldom will we be called to make the supreme sacrifice as these men did, but, we are all called before the Almighty God to pursue that which is right and good insofar as our abilities allow, considering neither the opinion of those around us nor the difficulties of the path ahead, but ever fulfilling our duty.



British soldiers take up a position behind barrels in a Dublin Street during the uprising.

Companions Who to Choose?

Fr Bede Jarrett

From his book *Meditations for Layfolk*, written in 1915.

Beyond the narrow borders of friendship is the vast territory of acquaintanceship. Friends must be few, but acquaintances will probably be very many—innumerable. We elect our friends, but our acquaintances come to us in a thousand ways. Our friends are chosen with care, but our companions by mere chance: and that precisely is our danger. A friend to whom we open our whole soul, who knows us through and through, and from whom we conscientiously keep back no reserves, is obviously a person whose influence over us must be considerable. We know each other so well and are so frank with each other that the evil of one must almost necessarily tarnish the other’s soul, as the good of one must refine the other. The need, therefore, to be careful in our choice is so plain, so natural, that choice will be made very deliberately. We take infinite pains about it and require a good deal of assurance before we really give ourselves into another’s hands. But we are apt to forget that really something very similar is happening even with our mere acquaintances namely, an appreciable influence on our lives; yet how careless we are about those with whom we mix! Of course, certain comrades are forced upon us by our

neighbourhood, by our work, by our relationships: certain people in life we can hardly with decency avoid. But there are numbers of others who have no call or claim upon us and into whose company we let ourselves slide.

There may be no harm in them, but the point is that we make no effort to see whether there is harm or no. And yet how often our sins come from our company! Our friends we cannot always be with; from our company we can never escape. Our friend is tethered to his place of business, to his home, to his several duties; but our acquaintances are with us all the day. At our business while we work they are beside us; we listen to their language, to their views of life expounded without reticence or modification. We stroll out to lunch between whiles and are once again, as every week-day, with the same set, in the midst of the same ideas, bathed in the same flood of jest and anecdote and latest social happenings. Does it not seem as though friendship itself (unless it be loyally and unswervingly guarded) would be out-voted in our lives by the circle of our acquaintances? What chance has it or has anything against the persistent, unescapable influence of our company? The endless tales (not quite the kind of thing that becomes a Christian), the gross conversation (coarse and vulgar perhaps rather than evil), the uncharitable gossip, the latest ugly rumour, the jealousy, the rivalry in dress and outward living, the small untruths to make ourselves appear just more important than we are, the first-hand information which is really not quite first-hand, all the mean and petty devices and subterfuges into which we find ourselves forced by our comrades. Is not companionship the

cause of very much that is evil?

I come, therefore, to this point—namely, that the influence of my company is very considerable, and, secondly, that most of my company is chosen purely at haphazard. Now it is obvious that some of my acquaintances I cannot avoid. What can I do about these? Be prepared. I know more or less when I am likely to meet them; I know also in what way I am likely to be influenced by their conduct or conversation. I know from experience just where temptation to agree or accept or propose comes to me, and in what particular matter the temptation lies. Very well, then, even if I cannot escape them, I can be on my guard. I can make my ejaculations for help, courage, light, to see what is right and to say or do it, fearlessly, uncowed, unashamed. There may be a

materialistic view to be refused, if not refuted; a disloyalty to faith to be denounced, at least in silence. To be forewarned is to be fore-armed. And when social conventions and the stress of work are satisfied, do I still cling to them, even when I have found their company to influence me and not for good? do I still seek their presence by sheer haphazard? Am I careful enough in selecting my company? for I cannot but admit the subtle moulding influence they must have on me, modifying my views, refining or coarsening my ideals, accustoming my ears and finally my tongue to language and jest and anecdote. Let me look at those with whom I choose, day after day, to have my meals, my work, my amusements. How far in their company do I defend justice and truth and my friends?



In humility, owing to our fallen human nature, we must accept that we are influenced by our companions more than we realise.

The Work of a Christian Father

The Father's Role of Government

Fr W. Cramer SJ

In our liberal world, the reality of authority is often uncomfortable to even the most pious Catholic men. In Catholicism, God gives a share of his authority to man, for some purpose in maintaining and spreading God's dominion. For most men, their encounter with this reality is the responsibility that God places on them as fathers. As Christian men have fallen away from these truths of natural law, we find ourselves unwilling to exercise our God-given authority in the home. From his work The Christian Father, Fr Cramer reminds us of our duties as fathers and heads of households.

We have dwelt at some length on this subject in the preceding chapters. We were then working at the foundation of a structure that reaches into eternity, and the foundation of such a structure must be solid and firm. The father must be Christian; all depends on this. All will admit that the welfare of the world, especially in our day, depends, after God, on the father and mother. But it is asked, what qualifications must a father and mother possess in order to promote this welfare? The answer is that although there are many qualifications required to attain this end, the first and most important is that a father and mother be truly Christian in spirit.

Now if we have succeeded in showing how important a Christian spirit is for a father in order to succeed in the education of his children it will be readily admitted that it was very proper to treat of this subject at some length. It was not enough to tell a father how important it is, and to encourage him; it was necessary also to explain in detail what is to be avoided and what is to be done in order to acquire this true Christian spirit and persevere in it.

We will now speak of the vocation of the father, of what a Christian father must do to execute faithfully that great work—the education of his children. It is not, however, our purpose to treat the subject of the Christian education of children in all its details; it would swell our little book to a large volume, which few would be able to purchase and read. We intend simply to explain the most necessary points of this subject. This will be enough. A true Christian spirit is, according to our supposition, the most necessary thing for a father. If he understands this well he will undoubtedly, with the divine assistance, be able to discover the right way in the education of his children.

I. "Lay up to Yourself Treasures."

In speaking of the education of children the above sounds as if we meant to insinuate a doctrine which, according to Christian principles, ought not to hold the first place, namely, the worldly welfare of

the children, or the acquiring of riches for them.

But let us explain. The labor and exertions of the father for the temporal welfare of his children is, of course, a part of his work, even according to Christian principles. The Lord has imposed on him the task of acquiring what is necessary or desirable for the proper support of his children, for their clothing, for their instruction in useful and necessary things, and also that he may be able to assist them, at the proper time, to earn their own livelihood according to their station in life. But it is not necessary to exhort or encourage fathers to do this for their children; they feel a natural impulse to do it. And indeed we have no fault to find with a father for exerting himself to provide comfortably for his children if he does not forget what is more important—his and their eternal welfare. It is right for father and mother to strive to leave a competency to their children, providing they at the same time secure for them that rich treasure, the grace of true Christian piety and the fear of God. But this worldly wealth would be too dearly bought, no matter how valuable it might be, if in order to obtain it parents and children should suffer spiritual damage. It would not be difficult to prove by examples taken from everyday life that those children to whom much has been given are not the happiest, or as happy as those who have received from their parents a good Christian education.

We therefore do not speak here of riches which are to be left to the children, but of riches which the father is to lay up for himself by working for the temporal welfare of his children.

Let us begin with a story. We knew a man who was not blessed with children. One day while listening to a sermon the following words made a strong impression on him: "Whosoever shall receive this child in my name receiveth me" (Luke ix. 48). These words left him no rest, and this thought troubled his mind: Perhaps God had not given him children that he might take care of poor, destitute orphan children. He resolved to obey the inspiration, and his wife seconded his resolution with all her heart. It was not long before he received the first child, an orphan. Others soon followed, until he had six in all—six poor, forsaken orphans. No one who did not know would ever have thought they were not his own with such energy did he follow his daily avocations in order to pro-

"Well, then, let us make the application. Do you, O father, do less for your own children than this noble-minded foster-father did for his adopted children?"

vide for his numerous little family. Everything necessary was provided for them, every care taken of them.

What impression, Christian father, does this story make on you? You who well know from experience what an amount of labor, sacrifice, patience, and care one—two—three—six children cost from day to day, for years! We are not mistaken when we say that this foster-father "had laid up to himself treasures in heaven" (Matth. vi. 20).

We must admit this to be the case if we consider how much these children daily cost him and how much he had to exert himself to provide for them. If we remember that the Lord will not permit a cup of cold water given for His sake to go unrewarded, how great must be the reward of this father who for years had daily given and done so much.

Well, then, let us make the application. Do you, O father, do less for your own children than this noble-minded foster-father did for his adopted children? O no; you do the same, or, perhaps, even more. What expense you must go to daily—and for years! How you must work and exert yourself day after day and year after year! How much you must suffer and endure all this time! Can we not say of you what we have said of that foster-father: What a great treasure you have laid up to yourself in heaven, and what a reward awaits you! Or does it make any difference that you work and suffer for your own children while he worked and suffered for those whom he had adopted? Are not your children equally as pleasing to God as the adopted children? Or is it less meritorious to labor and suffer for your own children?

No, it is the same.

But let us proceed. What is it that renders the action of the foster-father so meritorious? Is it not because he worked and suffered for those poor orphans? Of course it is; and yet there is still a better reason for it. It is because he did it for the love of God and out of Christian love for the children. Here we have at last come to the point. Do you, O Christian father, do all

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Knowing that his authority comes directly from God, a father should not wait for anyone's permission to do his duty.

May 19: St Yvo

Heralding From Brittany

Fr Alban Butler

From Butler's Lives of the Saints, Benziger Brothers Edition published in 1888.

St. Yvo Helori, descended from a noble and virtuous family near Treguier, in Brittany, was born in 1253. At fourteen years of age he went to Paris, and afterwards to Orleans, to pursue his studies. His mother was won frequently to say to him that he ought so to live as became a Saint, to which his answer always was, that he hoped to be one. This resolution took deep root in his soul, and was a continual spur to virtue, and a check against the least shadow of any dangerous course. His

time was chiefly divided between study and prayer; for his recreation he visited the hospitals, where he attended the sick with great charity, and comforted them under the severe trials of their suffering condition. He made a private vow of perpetual chastity; but this not being known, many honorable matches were proposed to him, which he modestly rejected as incompatible with his studious life. He long deliberated whether to embrace a religious or a clerical state; but the desire of serving his neighbor determined him at length in favor of the latter. He wished, out of humility, to remain in the lesser orders; but his bishop compelled him to receive the priesthood—a step which cost him many tears, though he had qualified

himself for that sacred dignity by the most perfect purity of mind and body, and by a long and fervent preparation. He was appointed ecclesiastical judge for the diocese of Rennes. St. Yvo protected the orphans and widows, defended the poor, and administered justice to all with an impartiality, application, and tenderness which gained him the good-will even of those who lost their causes. He was surnamed the advocate and lawyer of the poor. He built a house near his own for a hospital of the poor and sick; he washed their feet, cleansed their ulcers, served them at table, and ate himself only the scraps which they had left. He distributed his corn, or the price for which he sold it, among the poor immediately after the harvest. When a certain person endeavored to persuade him to keep it some months, that he might sell it at a better price, he answered, "I know not whether I shall be then alive to give it." Another time the same person said to him, "I have gained a fifth by keeping my corn." "But I," replied the Saint, "a hundredfold by giving it immediately away." During the Lent of 1303 he felt his strength failing him; yet, far from abating anything in his austerities, he thought

himself obliged to redouble his fervor in proportion as he advanced nearer to eternity. On the eve of the Ascension he preached to his people, said Mass, being upheld by two persons, and gave advice to all who addressed themselves to him. After this he lay down on his bed, which was a hurdle of twigs plaited together, and received the last sacraments. From that moment he entertained himself with God alone, till his soul went to possess Him in His glory. His death happened on the 19th of May 1303, in the fiftieth year of his age.

Reflection: St. Yvo was a Saint amidst the dangers of the world; but he preserved his virtue untainted only by arming himself carefully against them, by conversing assiduously with God in prayer and holy meditation, and by most watchfully shunning the snares of bad company. Without this precaution all the instructions of parents and all other means of virtue are ineffectual; and the soul is sure to split against this rock which does not steer wide of it.



The Work of a Christian Father Cont.

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you do for your children for the love of God and out of true Christian love for your children? Then you are like that foster-father, and we can likewise say of you: What a treasure of merit, what a reward you will reap!

In this way the whole life of a father is an uninterrupted work of mercy. And what a work of mercy! What else is it than relieving the wants of our neighbor for God's sake and out of Christian love? Now almost the whole life of a Christian father consists in working, caring, and exerting himself for his children—to give them food, to clothe and lodge them, to teach, counsel, and console them, to pardon them, and, if sick, to heal them. If a father is animated by love for God and for his children his life will be a succession of works of charity and mercy.

How highly does God value works of mercy! How great the reward promised for time and eternity!

Behold then, O Christian father, you are in a position to reap these blessings of Christian mercy during your life and for all eternity. It is only necessary that all you do out of natural love for your children be not done from necessity, but from love of God and Christian love for them.

You should consider your children as confided to you by God, who is your Master; and what you do and suffer for them you should consider as belonging to your vocation, and thus accept and bear all with a cheerful heart, from love to God and your children. Then indeed will your daily life be pleasing to God and a work of mercy to your children. Works of mercy thus interwoven in a man's life are a perpetual prayer to God for grace and mercy for him who has performed them. Behold how rich you can become by means of your children! The more there are and the more you suffer and endure for them the richer you will be.

Will not this reflection reconcile you to the hardships of which your children are the cause, and preserve you from ill-humor and impatience? Human efforts and exer-

tions never find so rich a reward as when they are performed in the service of him who is the great rewarder, or when they are done for the good of those who are so dear to him. In fact, the most profitable work on earth is the Christian work of a father—of parents for their children.

How much then it is to be regretted that parents—that fathers—see nothing in their daily labor for their children but the unpleasantness and burden of it, and who therefore perform such labor as if under compulsion and against their will! They thus make that work an almost unbearable cross; they lose the great reward promised them; they even commit sin! How much it is to be regretted that parents are but too often actuated only by natural motives in their efforts for their children, and therefore that they will receive no reward in eternity.

Take care, therefore, Christian father, to labor for your children in a Christian spirit. This you can do if you are truly a Christian father.

II. Government.—Discipline.

It is clear from the above words that we intend to speak of education, and to explain a point which is undoubtedly of great importance to a father in bringing up his children. According to the words of the divine Father, "Man is the head of the woman" (I. Cor. xi. 3), and consequently the head of the whole family. He is therefore the master of the house, and must rule and govern, of course in a Christian spirit, because he is a Christian father, and as such must show love and affection for those who are and must be subject to him. "Husbands, love your wives as Christ also loved the Church" (Eph. v. 25). And is there a Christian father, who does not love his children? His government must therefore be regulated by love and moderation, without, however, ceasing to be a government. He must guide and direct if the work of education is to advance.

Where is there a State that has no head or supreme magistrate? We all know that without such a head no State or society can

exist. There will and must be an emperor, king, president, congress, or some other supreme authority. This authority enforces existing laws and sanctions laws which are to be enacted. It watches and sees that the laws are observed, and it punishes the transgressors of the law. You will find the same order of things existing in the Church. There is a head over all, and heads over communities; there is law and supervision of its observance; there is punishment inflicted on the transgressors of the law. It cannot be otherwise; it must be so, in State and Church, if society is to exist and prosper.

Now the same is the case in the family. If the family is to prosper, if the education of the children is to advance, there must be a governing hand ruling all things; the family must have a head, and God has in fact appointed a head for it—it is the father. He (with the mother) lays down the law, the rules, the order to be observed; he watches over the discipline of the family and exercises the right of punishment.

Law, Rule and Order

The family, according to the providence of God, is the nursery for Church and State. In it the children should grow up to be useful citizens and good Christians, so that on leaving the paternal roof they may be worthy members of Church and State.

There are such nurseries established by the Church, called seminaries, where young men are taught to become worthy members of the ministry. To fit the pupils to become good priests by instilling into them the true spirit of their vocation, and thus render them capable of performing the duties of their high calling; such is the object in establishing seminaries.

Everything in a seminary is directed to this end. There are rules for the daily life and conduct of the students, compiled by the superiors after long experience and mature deliberation, the details of which are calculated to regulate the life and occupations of the students in such a manner as to attain the end and purpose of such an institution. The hour of rising in the morning and retiring at night is fixed by rule; there is a fixed time for breakfast, dinner, and supper, and for the daily recreations. Certain spiritual exercises are prescribed, such as morning and evening prayer, meditation, hearing Mass, receiving the sacraments, etc. There is also a time fixed for study. Rules are laid down to regulate the intercourse of the students with each other, etc. This is the rule, the law, and the superior of the seminary regulates all accordingly. He has an eye to the observance of the rules; he admonishes, and, if need be, punishes the transgressors. The more faithfully he does this the better he understands how to lead the students to observe conscientiously and strictly the rules and laws, and to regulate their daily life according to them; and thus the object and aim of the seminary is attained, and the students will go forth worthy and zealous priests. Without rule, law, and order, and the observance of them, this could not be the case.

We have called the family the nursery for Church and State. If, then, it is to fulfil its purpose, and bring up useful and worthy members of Church and State, it must, like a seminary, have its laws, rules, and regulations, and the father, who is the superior and head of the family, must see that these rules and laws are duly observed.

We do not require for the family the rules and laws of the seminary, which determine and regulate the minutest details of daily life; it would be impossible to ob-

"According to the words of the divine Father, "Man is the head of the woman" (I. Cor. xi. 3), and consequently the head of the whole family."

serve such rules in the family. Yet there must be certain rules and laws in the family if the education of the children is to be successfully conducted. Without them nothing will succeed; without them the children will neither be good members of society nor good Christians.

There is a general rule and law for every Christian family; it is the law of the divine will. This is an indispensable law, and the father must see that it is observed. Nothing can be tolerated that is contrary to the divine will, and what God commands must be done.

According to this, all improper customs and habits are to be excluded from the Christian family—the habit of giving way to anger, of scolding and swearing; the bad habit of lying and backbiting; in a special manner all dissolute and impious conversation; every disedifying remark against the doctrines and customs of the Church,—all these must be absolutely forbidden.

On the contrary, all that is truly Christian and in accordance with God's will ought to be cherished in the Christian household. Grace is said before and after meals; prayer is said morning and evening; servile work is not permitted on Sunday or holy days, unless through necessity; the members of the household attend Mass and assist at the other devotions of the Church; they go to confession, and receive holy communion; they observe the days of fasting and abstinence, etc.; the works of charity and mercy are not forgotten, for love and sympathy animate all; and to complete the list we must include sobriety, purity, diligence, fervor, cleanliness, etc.

Need we add that it is a great blessing for children when such laws and order exist in the family, and when they grow up under their influence and become accustomed to them. Will they not become good men and women and good Christians? But poor and unfortunate children when there is no such order in the family; when they are constantly witnessing transgressions against the divine will, and offences against Christian propriety and morals! Will it not require a miracle to make such children good under the circumstances?

We have thus far explained the principal point of our subject, for the proper method of bringing up children consists in this, that law and order should reign in the family, and that the father and mother should enforce them. We however wish to treat of this subject more at length.

As the father has been appointed by God the head of the family he has in virtue of that appointment the authority to make laws and rules for the members of the family, particularly for his children; and if his rules and laws are not contrary to the will of God they have the same binding force as the commandments of God. In virtue of this authority, then, the father should ordain and determine all that is necessary and useful to bring up his children good citizens and Christians. For that purpose he might select some rules from the ecclesiastical seminary, and he can insist on their observance. The hour of rising in the morning and retiring in the evening; the time for breakfast, dinner, and supper, and the time for work and recreation; all these should be fixed and determined, and faith-

Continued on Page 8



Peace is the tranquility of order, and a home is not in order if the father is not the head.

The Work of a Christian Father Cont.

Continued from Page 7

fully observed as far as possible.

We say as far as possible, for we know very well that through necessity exceptions must be made; but we know also that it is very possible to keep the exceptions in the minority, and thus on the whole the rule remains in force. This is of great importance for the children, for you cannot sufficiently appreciate the blessing and the advantage of accustomed children to a well regulated life. It causes a certain freshness and joy of heart in daily life which renders easy the performance of their daily duties. “God,” says St. Augustine, “is a God of order; he, therefore, who lives according to

order lives according to God.” And St. Bernard says, “My brethren, I warn you in the Lord, be diligent in preserving order that order may preserve you.”

It is not to be left to the pleasure of the children when they may leave the house or when they should return.

The father or mother must give them permission to go and appoint the time when they must return. An hour should be set when all the members of the family must be at home, or the doors closed and locked on them.

As it is the duty of the father and mother to assign to each member of the family that part of the daily work which each must perform, they should have regard to the ability of their little subjects, to their likes and dislikes for certain kinds of work, and, if possible, gratify their inclination; they should, moreover, once and for all, give a certain work to a certain member of the family; the work is thereby made easier, the workman acquires a certain independence, and all is done well. Let us add to this that the father and mother must determine when the sacraments are to be received; they must also establish fixed rules in regard to going out to evening parties, inviting company, etc.; and finally, it must be understood that sons and daughters cannot do what they please, particularly if it be of importance, without the knowledge and consent of the father.

“If the family is to prosper, if the education of the children is to advance, there must be a governing hand ruling all things; the family must have a head, and God has in fact appointed a head for it—it is the father.”

We have now given a sketch of the rules and laws of a Christian family. They must apply to all the members of the household, and the duty of the father is to see that they are observed.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR



Belgium

I am from Belgium and my wife went down to see what should I do?

Make her read The Plough. I am really sorry to hear about that. I guess she didn't grow up in a traditional Catholic and go to a traditional Catholic school. That really sucks. Oh well.

Agenda

Dear Editor, I was disappointed to read your article on 10 May "Young people don't read". I am tired of reading stories talking all young people as something bad or selfish, when this is just not true!

As a young person, I play tennis and softball, help out as a volunteer for my fellow students, and do volunteer work in my community. I also care about my family and friends, and I am genuinely about issues that some members think that I am willing to put out the best some months people that I am willing to put out the best and do volunteer work in my community.

I also care about my family and friends, and I am genuinely about issues that affect them. I don't care what's happening. It's that selfish. Don't ask or don't want to know to what young people have to say.

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Dr. Heine is a great man. The Plough

Building Power outside the Jewish House

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Don't ask or don't want to know to what young people have to say

Read The Plough

Read Argentina's City of Man

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Visit

theplough.ink/contribute

to send a letter in.

On Earth as it is in Heaven

A Response to Arthur Penty

Ramiro de Maetzu

Ramiro de Maetzu, a spanish writer at the beginning of the 20th century concurs with Arthur Penty's analysis of the degradation of the guilds being attributed to the re-emergence of Roman Law. The April 2026 issue of The Plough covers Mr Penty's original analysis, while this article provides the sequel.

The central point in “A Guildsman’s Interpretation of History,” which is, if I am not mistaken, Mr. Penty’s masterpiece, is his attack on Roman Law. Mr. Penty accuses Roman Law of having destroyed the Christian organisation of human societies which the Church, with her canon law, and the barbarians, with their common law, had elaborated during the Middle Ages. Why was the promise of the thirteenth century not fulfilled : St. Dominic, St. Francis, St. Thomas, the Guilds, the Gothic Cathedrals, the Universities, the primacy of spiritual power? According to Mr. Penty, because Roman Law, revived by the lawyers, induced the master-craftsmen of Guilds to forget their duties towards their workmen and the public, and to become mere masters in the actual sense of the word; it persuaded the feudal lords to abandon their duties towards their serfs and freeholders and to become mere

landowners; and it led the princes to emancipate themselves from the Emperor and the Pope and thus was restored the Roman concept of sovereignty which even to-day has made the League of Nations impossible. By means of these two apples, of property and sovereignty, dominium and imperium, the legal Serpent brought about the fall of mediaeval society. “The Bible of the Devil,” Heine called the Codex of the Roman Civil Law.

Had the natural course of events not been interrupted, Canon law and Common law would have blended in a lasting synthesis. They are not incompatible, but complementary. The Common law was the natural expression among the barbarians of military, aristocratic and communist societies, in which the men owed loyalty to the leaders and the leaders military protection to the men and devotion to the common interests of the tribe. Canon law, based on the supposition that all justice proceeds from God, looked upon the ruler merely as a functionary whose powers were conditioned by the fulfilment of his duties. In both cases the common good was the object of the laws. “Laws have been made,” said Fuero Juzgo, “to enable good men to live among bad.” But Roman law set itself, Mr. Penty tells us, to enable rich men to live among the poor. It was not made to secure the common good, but only to avoid disputes among neighbours by granting to

them absolute property in the lands they cultivated, and by establishing a supreme power in order to enforce the fulfilment of contracts.

It was in vain that the Church repeatedly condemned Roman law. In 1180 Pope Alexander III forbade the monks to study the Justinian Codex. In 1219 Pope Honorius III extended the prohibition to all priests ; and in 1220, to the laity of the Paris University. In 1254 Pope Innocent IV extended the prohibition to France, England, Holland, Spain and Italy. But Roman law prevailed because it promoted the interests of the princes and great lords, and although the English imagine themselves to be ruled by the Common law and not by the Roman, and it is possible to justify their belief historically, the truth is that the concepts of Roman law have taken possession of Common law, and that Roman law is to-day in England, as it has been always and everywhere, the bulwark of private interests against the common interest. And what chiefly moved the lawyers of the Middle Ages to revive Roman law, was that horror of creative thought which in all times has made men in general and lawyers in particular prefer the work of compilation, gloss and translation to that of directly confronting problems and solving them originally.

We now live in societies contradictorily ruled by a religious principle, which orders us to love our neighbours as ourselves, and a juridical principle, which authorises us (and in this case authorisation is virtually a command) to buy in the cheapest market and to sell in the dearest. The social question may be defined as the con-

tradition that exists between our religious and our legal norms. The revolutionaries would like to resolve the contradiction by the simultaneous abolition of both norms, and by the establishment by violence of the communist principle in society. This might appear plausible to those who have not grasped the fact that a communist society cannot last unless it is based on a principle of love for our neighbours, and that the principle of love is not natural, but supernatural, for there is nothing in our nature that makes us love our neighbour as ourselves. The contradiction might also be resolved by upholding the juridical norm where necessary, against the religious ; and this is the real desire of those who advocate the crushing by violence of all effective protest against the prevalence of Roman law. For I am certain that there are many more partisans of the restoration of pagan slavery than those who are prepared to profess it publicly. But it is also possible to resolve the contradiction that lies at the root of our unrest by adjusting the juridical norm to the Christian precept; and it is this that Mr. Penty aims at in his criticism of Roman law and his defence of Mediaeval law. I need not add that I agree with Mr. Penty, because I have already said that the way to transform law satisfactorily consists in submitting the principles of sovereignty and property, of imperium and dominium, of authority and liberty, to the superior principle of function, and that the function of man is to maintain and increase on earth the good things of heaven.



In Praise of the New Knighthood

St Bernard Confers His Blessing on the Knights Templar

St Bernard of Clairvaux

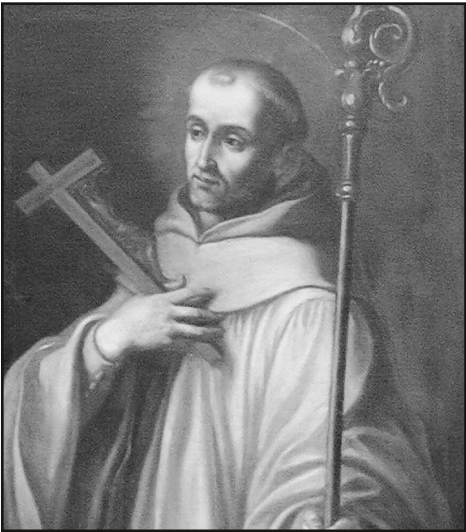
St Bernard wrote a letter to a Sir Hugh, a Knight of a new order, giving his blessing and advice to what would become the Knights Templar. Written circa 1120.

Prologue

To Hugh, Knight of Christ and Master of Christ’s Militia: Bernard, Abbot of Clairvaux in name only, wishes that he may fight the good fight.

If I am not mistaken, my dear Hugh, you have asked me not once or twice, but three times to write a few words of exhortation for you and your comrades. You say that, while I am not permitted to wield the lance, I might at least brandish my pen against a tyrannical foe, and that this moral, rather than material, support of mine will be of no small help to you. I have put you off now for quite some time, not because I scorn your request, but for fear I may be blamed for accepting lightly and hastily, or that I may botch a task which might better be done by a more qualified hand and which might, because of me, still remain just as requisite and that much more difficult.

Having waited quite some time to no purpose, I have now done what I could, lest



St Bernard of Clairvaux 1090–1153.

inability be mistaken for unwillingness. It is for the reader to judge the result. Although some may find my work unsatisfactory or short of the mark, I shall be nonetheless content, for I have not failed to give you my best.

A Word of Exhortation for The Knights of The Temple

A new kind of knighthood seems recently to have appeared on the earth, and in that part of the world which the Orient from on high once visited in the flesh. As He then drove out the powers of darkness by the strength of his mighty hand, so He now drives out their supporters, the children of disbelief, scattering them by the hand of His might. Even now He brings about the redemption of His people, and again raises up for us a horn of salvation in the house of His servant David.

This, I repeat, is a new kind of knighthood and one unknown in ages past. It indefatigably wages a twofold combat, against flesh and blood and against a spiritual hosts of evil in the heavens. When someone bravely resists a physical foe, relying solely on physical strength, I find this hardly astounding, since this is not uncommon. And when war is waged by spiritual strength against vices or demons, this, too, is nothing remarkable, though I consider it praiseworthy, for the world is full of monks. But for a man powerfully to gird himself with both swords and nobly mark his belt—who would not consider this very worthy of great admiration, even more so since it has hitherto been unknown? Truly a fearless knight and secure on every side is he whose soul is protected by the armor of faith just as his body is protected by armor of steel. Doubly armed, surely, he need fear neither demons nor men. Not that he fears death—no, he desires it. Why should he fear to live or to die when for him to live is Christ, and to die is gain? Gladly and faithfully he stands up for Christ, but he would prefer to be dissolved and to be with Christ, by far the better thing.

March forth confidently then, you

knights, and with a stalwart heart repel the foes of the cross of Christ. Be sure that neither death nor life can separate you from the love of God which is in Jesus Christ. In every peril repeat, ‘Whether we live or whether we die, we are the Lord’. How gloriously victors return from battle! How blessedly martyrs die in battle! Rejoice, brave athlete, if you live and conquer in the Lord; but glory and exult still more if you die and join your Lord. Life is indeed fruitful and victory glorious, but more important than either is a holy death. If they are blessed who die in the Lord, how much more so are those who die for the Lord!

Precious indeed in the sight of the Lord is the death of his holy ones, whether they die in battle or in bed, but death in battle is more precious as it is more glorious. How secure life is when the conscience is pure! How secure I say, life is, when death is regarded without fear; indeed, when it is anticipated with composure and accepted with reverence! How truly holy and secure this knighthood and how entirely free of the double risk run by the kind of men who are often at risk, but who do not fight for Christ’s cause! Whenever you march out, o worldly warrior, you have to worry that killing your foe’s body may mean killing your soul, or that by him you may be killed, body and soul both.

Indeed, danger or victory for the Christian are weighed by the focus of the heart, not the fortunes of war. If he fights for a good cause, the outcome of the battle can never be evil; and likewise the result can never be considered good if the cause is evil and the intention unrighteous. If you happen to be killed while you intend to kill another, you die a murderer. If you prevail and by your intention of overcoming and conquering you perhaps kill a man, you live a murderer. Yet to be a murderer, whether living or dead, victorious or vanquished, is not a good thing. What an unhappy victory—to have conquered a man while yielding to vice. And if anger or arrogance have got the best of you, in vain

“Doubly armed, surely, he need fear neither demons nor men. Not that he fears death—no, he desires it. Why should he fear to live or to die when for him to live is Christ, and to die is gain?”

do you boast over the fallen enemy.

But what of those who kill neither in the fury of vengeance nor the frenzy of conquest, but simply in self-defence? Even this sort of victory I would not call a good victory, since of the two, physical death is a lesser evil than spiritual. The soul need not die when the body is slain. No, it is the soul which sins that shall die.

On Worldly Knighthood

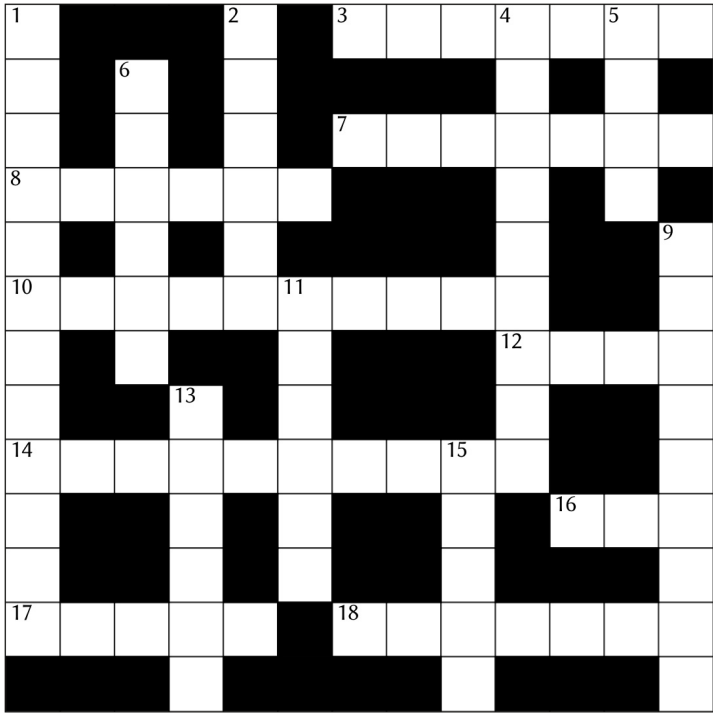
What is the goal of the worldly—I will call it, not knighthood, but—knavery? What if not the mortal sin of the victor and the eternal death of the vanquished? Well then, to borrow a word from the Apostle, let someone who plows, plow in hope, and someone who threshes, do so in view of garnering the grain.

What then, O knights, is this stupendous misapprehension and what this unbearable impulse which bids you fight with such pomp and pains, and all to no purpose save death and sin? You drape your horses in silk, and plume your armor with I know not what sort of rags; you paint your shields and your saddles; you adorn your bits and spurs with gold and silver and precious stones, and then in all this pomp, with shameful wrath and fearless folly, you charge to your death. Are these the trappings of a warrior or are they not rather the trinkets of a woman? Do you think the swords of your foes will be deflected by your gold, spare your jewels or fail to

Continued on Page 10

PUZZLES FOR THE LETTERED FOLK

CROSSWORD



- Across**
- 3) A person without The Faith i.e. a Mohamedan (7)
 - 7) The nation of the German race in The Alps (7)
 - 8) Those created that are in heaven (6)
 - 10) To speak against or in opposition (10)
 - 12) Used for flattening creases on garments and linens (4)
 - 14) In the Diocese of Campos, Brazil, absolution was withheld if the penitent didn't resolve to remove this from their house (10)
 - 16) A hard, dry, shelled fruit containing a tree seed (3)
 - 17) A simple creature of pure spirit (5)
 - 18) That which replaces the altar bells in the liturgy during the Sacred Triduum (7)
- Down**
- 1) The Latin name for a sung mass (5-7)
 - 2) Wine-maker (6)
 - 4) Method of arriving at knowledge without obvious reasoning process (9)
 - 5) The privation of good (4)
 - 6) The East (6)
 - 9) A monk's home (9)
 - 11) An ancient term for the Isle of Britain, particularly the English part (6)
 - 13) One who transforms thread to cloth (6)
 - 15) Keyboard instrument that sounds by air resonating in pipes (5)

CALTROP SWEEPER

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In Praise of the New Knighthood Cont.

Continued from Page 9

pierce your silks?

As you yourselves have often certainly experienced, there are three things especially needful to a warrior: a knight must guard his person with vigor, shrewdness, and caution; he must be unimpeded in his movements, and he must be quick to draw his sword. You, by contrast, blind yourselves with effeminate tresses and trip yourselves up with long, voluminous tunics, burying your tender, delicate hands in cumbersome, flowing sleeves. Over and above all this, there is that terrible insecurity of conscience, in spite of all your armor, since you have dared to undertake so dangerous a business on such slight and frivolous grounds. Nothing stirs you to battle or rouses you to disputes, really, except flashes of irrational anger, hunger for empty glory, or hankering after some earthly possessions? For causes like these it certainly is not safe to kill or to be killed.

On the New Knighthood

But the knights of Christ may safely do battle in the battles of their Lord, fearing neither the sin of smiting the enemy nor the danger of their own downfall, inasmuch as death for Christ, inflicted or endured, bears no taint of sin, but deserves abundant glory. In the first case one gains for Christ, and in the second one gains Christ himself, who freely accepts the death of the foe in vengeance, and yet more freely gives himself in consolation to

his fallen knight.

The knight of Christ, I say, may strike with confidence and succumb more confidently. When he strikes, he does service to Christ, and to himself when he succumbs. Nor does he bear the sword in vain. He is God's minister in the punishment of evil-doers and the praise of well doers. Surely, if he kills an evil-doer, he is not a man-killer, but, if I may so put it, an evil-killer. Clearly he is reckoned the avenger of Christ against evildoers, and the defender of Christians. Should he be killed himself, we know he has not perished, but has come safely home. The death which he inflicts is Christ's gain, and that which he suffers, his own. At the death of the pagan, the Christian exults because Christ is exalted; in the death of the Christian the King's liberality is conspicuous when the knight is ushered home to be rewarded. In the one case a just person shall rejoice at regarding vindication; in the other man shall say, Truly there is a reward for the just; truly it is God who judges the earth.

Yet this is not to say that the pagans are to be slaughtered when there is any other way of preventing them from harassing and persecuting the faithful; but only that now it seems better to destroy them than to allow the rod of sinners to continue to be raised over the lot of the righteous, lest perchance the righteous set their hand to iniquity.

What then? If it is never legitimate for a Christian to strike with the sword, why then did the Saviour's precursor bid sol-

diers be content with their pay, and not rather ban military service to them? But if, as is the case, it is legitimate for all those ordained to it by the Almighty—provided they have not embraced a higher calling—then to whom, I ask, may it more rightly be allowed than to those into whose hands and hearts is committed on behalf of all of us Sion, the city of our strength? So that once the transgressors of divine law have been expelled, the righteous nation that preserves the truth may enter in surety.

Surely then the nations who choose warfare should be scattered, those who molest us should be cut away, and all the workers of iniquity should be dispersed from the city of the Lord—those who busy themselves carrying off the incalculable riches placed in Jerusalem by Christian people, profaning holy things and possessing the sanctuary of God as their heritage. Let both swords of the faithful fall upon the necks of the foe to the destruction of every lofty thing lifting itself up against the knowledge of God which is the Christian faith, lest the Gentiles should then say, ‘Where is their God?’

Once they have been cast out, He shall return to his heritage and to his house, of which he said in anger in the Gospel, "Behold, your house will be left to you desolate". And through the Prophet he had complained: "I have left my house, I have forsaken my heritage". And he will fulfill that other prophecy: "The Lord has ransomed his people and delivered them. They shall come to Mount Zion and exult, and rejoice in the good things of the Lord."

Rejoice Jerusalem, and recognize right now the time of your visitation! Be glad and give praise all at once, wastelands of Jerusalem, for the Lord has comforted his people. He has ransomed Jerusalem. The Lord has bared his holy arm in the sight of all the nations. O virgin Israel, you had fallen and there was no one to raise you up. Rise up now and shake off the dust, O virgin, captive daughter of Sion. Rise up, I say, and stand on high. Look at the happiness which is coming to you from your God. You will no longer be referred to as forsaken, nor your land any more be termed a wilderness, for the Lord has taken delight in you, and your land shall be peopled. Raise your eyes, look around you and see; all these have gathered together and come to you. This is help sent to you by the Holy One! Through them already is fulfilled the ancient promise, I will make you the pride of the ages, a joy from generation to generation. You will suck the milk of the nations and be nourished at the breasts of kings. And again, as a mother consoles her children, so will I console you, and in Jerusalem you will be consoled.

Do you not see how often these ancient witnesses authorize the new knighthood? Surely, what we have heard, we have now seen in the city of the Lord of hosts. At the same time, of course, we must not let this literal interpretation blind us to the spiritual meaning of the texts, for we must live in eternal hope in spite of such temporal realizations of prophetic utterances. Otherwise what is beheld would supplant what is believed, material penury threaten spiritual wealth and present possessions void future fulfillment. What is more, the temporal glory of the earthly city does not demolish its heavenly rewards, but demonstrates them, at least so long as we remember that the one is the figure of the other, and that it is the heavenly which is our mother.

On The Lifestyle of The Knights of The Temple

“What is more, the temporal glory of the earthly city does not demolish its heavenly rewards, but demonstrates them, at least so long as we remember that the one is the figure of the other, and that it is the heavenly which is our mother.”

And now as an exemplar, or at least an embarrassment, for those of our knights who are apparently fighting not for God, but for the devil, we will briefly set forth the life and virtues of these knights of Christ: how they conduct themselves at home as well as in battle, how they appear in public, and how the knighthood of God and of the world differ from one another.

First, discipline is in no way lacking, and obedience is never despised. As Scripture testifies, the undisciplined son shall perish, and rebellion is as much a sin as witchcraft, to refuse obedience is like the crime of idolatry. They come and they go at the bidding of their superior. They wear what he gives them and do not presume to wear or to eat anything from another source. Both in raiment and in rations they shun every excess and have regard only for what is necessary. They live in cheerful community and sober company, without wives and without children. So that their evangelical perfection will lack nothing, they dwell united in one family with no personal property whatever, careful to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace. You may say that the whole multitude has but one heart and one soul to the point that no one follows his own will, but seeks instead to follow the commander.

They never sit in idleness or wander about aimlessly, but on the rare occasions when they are not on duty, they are always careful to earn their bread by repairing their worn armor and torn clothing, or simply by setting things to order. For the rest, they are guided by the common needs and by the will of their master.

There is little distinction of persons

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A Templar Knight: founded in Jerusalem around 1119 by French knight Hugues de Payens, they were formed for the protection of pilgrims travelling to and within the Holy Land.

PUZZLE SOLUTIONS

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In Praise of the New Knighthood Cont.

Continued from Page 10

among them, and deference is shown to ability, not to nobility. They rival one another in mutual consideration, and they carry one another's burdens, thus fulfilling the law of Christ. No arrogant word, no idle deed, no unrestrained laugh, not even the slightest whisper or murmur, is left uncorrected once it has been detected. They foreswear dice and chess, they abhor the hunt; they take no delight, as is customary, in the ridiculous cruelty of falconry. Jesters, wizards, bards, bawdy minstrels and jousts, they despise and reject as so many vanities and deceitful follies. They cut their hair short, cognizant that, according to the Apostle, it is shameful for a man to cultivate flowing locks. They never dress, and seldom wash, their hair—content to let it appear tousled and dusty, darkened by chain mail and heat.

When a battle is at hand, they arm them-

selves interiorly with faith and exteriorly with steel rather than with gold. Thus armed and not embellished, they strike fear rather than incite greed in the enemy. They seek out strong, swift horses, rather than those which are dappled and well-plumed. They set their minds on fighting to win rather than on parading for show. They take no thought for glory but seek to be formidable rather than flamboyant. Then, too, they are not quarrelsome, reckless, or impulsively foolhardy, but they draw up their ranks deliberately, prudently, and providently, arraying themselves in the line of battle as we read about in the Fathers. Indeed, the true Israelites march into battle as men of peace.

Yet once in the thick of battle, they set aside this earlier gentleness, as if to say, "Do I not hate those who hate you, O Lord; am I not disgusted with your enemies?" These men charge the enemy, regarding the foe as sheep, never—no matter how

outnumbered they are—as ruthless barbarians or as awesome hordes. Nor do they presume on their own strength, but trust for victory in the Lord of Sabaoth. They are mindful of the words of Maccabees, "It is simple enough for a multitude to be vanquished by a handful. It makes no difference in the sight of the God of heaven whether He grants deliverance by the hands of few or of many; for victory in war does not depend on a big army, but bravery is the gift from heaven."

As they have on numerous occasions experienced, one man may pursue a thousand, and two put ten thousand to flight.

Thus, in an astounding and unique manner they appear gentler than lambs, yet fiercer than lions. Consequently, I do not know if it would be more appropriate to refer to them as monks or as soldiers, or whether it would perhaps be better to recognize them as being both, for they lack

"Yet once in the thick of battle, they set aside this earlier gentleness, as if to say, Do I not hate those who hate you, O Lord; am I not disgusted with your enemies?"

neither monastic meekness nor military might. What can we say about this, except that this is the Lord's doing, and it is marvelous in our eyes. God has hand-picked such troops, and from among the most valiant men of Israel he recruited from the ends of the earth servants to guard vigilantly and faithfully that sepulchre which is the bed of the true Solomon; all bearing sword in hand, and superbly trained to war.

Human Sacrifice Among The Hebrews

Infidelity From The Beginning

Fr Henri Desportes

From the The Mystery of Blood among the Jews of All Times, 1899. It received the following approbation from the local bishop in France: Bishopric of Séez, March 7, 1890.

Dear Monsieur, I have read attentively and not without interest your work entitled: The Mystery of Blood among the Jews of All Times. This book is undeniably relevant and likely to open the eyes of a great number of more or less willingly blind people. It will give rise in many hearts to sad reflections on the role played by so many Catholics these days. May it enlighten them. Please accept, dear Sir, the assurance of my devotion. + François-Marie, Bishop of Séez.

This work establishes and develops a serious accusation against the Jews of our time. It is curious to go back to the beginning of time and find there the germ of the instincts that have developed formidably in the Israelite people.

This people, whom some scholars have portrayed to us as full of the spirit of monotheism, were instead possessed by idolatrous fury.

Even under the rod of Moses and Aaron, the people, whom Christ reproaches for their sacrilegious inventions and false traditions, mixed with those that are part of divine law, constantly fall and fall back into the shameful superstitions of the foreigners who surround them. And not only do they worship the golden calf at the foot of Sinai, but their vicious inclination leads them to the most incredible abominations. They bear witness against themselves, and this testimony is eternal, for it is that of the books that their dispersion has spread among the peoples.

Undoubtedly, the law that God promulgated for them amidst the splendors of Sinai, was the most perfect law in the world, since it was not made by the hand of man. But how many times has this fickle people escaped this law, slipped from the very hands of God. Neither their inflexible legislators, nor their divine and pure law, nor their divine government, nor their priesthood could prevent them from faltering and falling into the deep abyss of

idolatry.

They could not come into contact with the foreign peoples who surrounded them without immediately indulging in their vices and abominations. They went in this way as far as all the deeply idolatrous peoples; to the false gods they offered in holocaust the blood of their own children.

"His fury for this religious crime," says Gougenot des Mousseaux, "was extreme, since so many pages of Scripture repeat time and time again the terrible threats of God against this habitual crime, that is to say against the acts of an idolatry which summarizes in its ritual all the monstrosities of the magical sabbaths; the vice of the cursed cities, of the Dead Sea and beyond: homicide and anthropophagy."

How many times have the prophets risen up against these bloody practices? The most terrible laws, the most rigorous punishments, the most penetrating oburgations, everything was employed and everything was useless.

"You shall not give any of your children to be consecrated to the idol of Moloch, and you shall not profane the name of your God... If a man from among the children of Israel or the strangers who dwell in Israel gives of his children to the idol of Moloch, let him be put to death and let the people of the land stone him."

It is in Leviticus that we read these formal prohibitions; which clearly shows that from the earliest times the chosen people were turning away from God and rushing to the cult of false gods. Barely out of Egypt, under the formidable eye of Moses, amidst the wonders that the Lord multiplied in his favor, the House of Israel carried, alongside the Ark of the Covenant, the tabernacle of Moloch with the head of a calf, the image of its homicidal divinities, the star of the god Rempham!

"When the Lord your God," repeats Deuteronomy, "has exterminated the nations whose land you are going to possess, and you dwell in their land, take good care not to imitate these nations, and to inquire about their ceremonies, saying: I want to follow myself the worship with which these nations have honored their gods."

"You shall not render similar worship to the Lord your God; for they have done to honor their gods all the abominations that

the Lord abhors, offering in sacrifice their sons and their daughters, and burning them in the fire."

Under the judges, we see many times the Jews return to the bloody cult of false gods. From time to time the envoys of God tear them from the abyss into which they roll again a few months later. It seems that the taste for blood, that the idea of bloody sacrifice was the very foundation of this people who never understood the marvelous history that God was weaving through them, using their coarse and savage hands. Also, the act of Jephthah—sacrificing, in an unheard-of blindness, his daughter to God himself who abhorred blood—does not seem to have aroused any reprobation. By dint of sacrificing human victims to Moloch, one became accustomed to thinking that Jehovah could be honored in the same way.

"They mingled with the nations," says the Psalmist "and they learned their works. They worshiped their carved idols: which was a cause of scandal for them. They immolated their sons and their daughters to demons. They shed innocent blood, the blood of their sons and their daughters... And the earth was infected by the abundance of blood they shed; it was defiled by their criminal works."

King Josiah had the vessels used for the worship of Baal and all the stars of heaven thrown out of the Temple. He exterminated the augurs established to sacrifice on the high places in the cities of Judah; he put to death those whose incense smoked in honor of the sun, the moon, the signs of the zodiac and the stars; they overthrew the medicules, built in the Temple, which served as a shelter for the fervent of the

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most infamous debaucheries. He profaned the high places, where the priests of the idols came to sacrifice from one end to the other of his States, without omitting those of Topheth, so that no one consecrated his son or his daughter to Moloch by fire; he removed the horses given to the sun by the kings of Judah, and burned the chariots of this god; he destroyed the altars erected on the dome of the chamber of Ahaz, and those that Manasseh had built in the two parvis of the temple of the Lord.

He profaned the high places to the right of the Mount of Offense, which Solomon had built for Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, for Chemosh the abomination of Moab, and for Moloch the abomination of the Ammonites; finally, he killed all the priests dedicated to the altars of the high places; he exterminated those who were inspired by a spirit of Python and removed from the midst of the people all that drove

Continued on Page #



Hebrew children being sacrificed to an idol of Moloch: Jeremias Chapter 32.



Human Sacrifice Among The Hebrews Cont.

Continued from Page 11

them to vile and abominable acts.

This reform, though radical, was not of long duration, and Israel quickly returned to the monstrosities it delighted in admitting into its worship. The Book of Wisdom speaks to us of the religion of these peoples whom the Jews loved to imitate: "They kill their own children without compassion; they eat the entrails of men; they drink the blood of human victims."

"Go," the Lord said to Jeremiah, "go to the valley of the son of Hinnom and say: Hear the word of the Lord, kings of Judah, and you inhabitants of Jerusalem. Thus says the Lord of hosts, the God of Israel: 'I am going to bring such disaster on this place that everyone who hears about it will be appalled. Because they have forsaken me and served foreign gods that their fathers did not know, and have filled this place with the blood of the innocent, and built high places to burn their children and offer them as burnt offerings to these gods, things I have not commanded, nor spoken of, nor did they ever enter my heart; therefore, behold, days are coming, when this place shall no longer be called the valley of Hinnom, but the valley of Slaughter.'"

Such were the excesses to which the chosen people stooped, despite the rigors of the old law. What will become of these possessed by idolatry when the right hand of God is no longer upon them, when the all-powerful help of the Most High has abandoned them, when the divine decree burdens their arms and blinds their eyes?

One can easily guess. All the evil instincts will develop mightily in a luxuriant vegetation, the spirit of superstition will stifle the spirit of religion, and the most hideous rites will become the characteristic feature of the synagogue. The infamous executioners of Golgotha, forsaken by God, cursed by Heaven, will roll from abyss to abyss, from darkness to darkness, to end in a nameless mire: they will no longer have prophets to snatch them from it, but rabbis to thrust them further into this vortex of infamy. They have scorned the Messiah—the light; they will no longer see the truth. This downfall is logical. It is also historical; let us show it.

The Talmud

At the time when Jesus the Nazarene was exercising his fruitful ministry in the lands of Judea, two main sects vied for influence over Israel.

The Sadducees—the materialists and epicureans of that time—though of royal lineage, rejected the spirituality of the soul; they soon came to deny the existence of angels and Satan. Exclusively occupied with pleasures and debauchery, they had only a rather limited influence over the mass of the nation.

The true leaders of the national party, the conductors of the people, were the

Pharisees. Taking the law literally, they had made themselves the organs of the traditional interpretation of scripture, "the doctors of casuistry." They pressured consciences and imposed revolting and impossible precepts. With them, everything was external: provided appearances were safeguarded, the man was just and holy, even if his soul was as covered with sins as the month of May is with flowers.

How often the Savior had risen up against these artificers of falsehood and hypocrisy, flagellating their superstitious practices, comparing them to whitewashed sepulchers, accusing them of putting their lying traditions above the law of God. We see from the Gospel that the oath hardly bothered them: to swear by the Temple and by the altar was nothing; for the oath to be binding, it had to be uttered on the gold of the temple, on the offerings placed on the altar. To these aberrations they added the most shameful vices, such as rapine and usury; they put the tithe on the goods of the poor and oppressed the widow and the orphan.

After the great sacrifice of the God-Man on the mountain of Calvary, these flaws worsened. It was they who were responsible for this death, and as punishment for their hardness of heart, they were struck with a fatal blindness. They continued to teach the people, but they moved further and further away from the Mosaic law; they soon came to forget it completely and to substitute their own doctrine for it. Thus, they gradually formed the Jews we know and developed immoderately the evil tendencies we have revealed in the first chapter.

Before the total dispersion of their co-religionists, the rabbis gathered their scattered teachings into a single code. This code was the Talmud. It has become the book of all truth for true Judaizers, and in this work, we shall designate by the name of Jews only the faithful of the savage and unsocial traditions of this code, in a word, the pure follower of Pharisaic orthodoxy. That is why it seemed useful to us to give first of all a short overview of the historical composition of the Talmud, and of the dogmatic and moral doctrines it contains. This is owed to a book that has had so much influence on the destinies of the Jewish nation and that, because of this, Christians should study closely. Perhaps they would find there the solution to serious problems.

The Talmud was written in the first centuries of the Christian era, in two different places, in Jerusalem and in Babylon; thus, two Talmuds are distinguished. Each bears the name of the city where it was composed.

The first idea for the Jerusalem Talmud is attributed to Rabbi Judah Ben-Simon, or Judah the Saint, great-grandson of Gamaliel I, who had been Saint Paul's teacher. He lived at the beginning of the

third century; he set down in writing the Mishna (second law) that he claimed to trace back to Moses through oral tradition. This was like the nucleus of the Talmud.

"It is the basis," writes Vigouroux, "the starting point and like the text of the code of which the Talmud itself is the commentary. Its authority is regarded as indisputable in Judaism. The language is Hebrew, mixed with Aramaic, Greek, and Latin expressions. There are some changes in the Babylonian Mishna. It is said that they were introduced into the text by R. Judah while the original version remained in force in Palestine."

It is mainly in the *ghemara* (commentary) that the difference between the two Talmuds lies. The Jerusalem one is much shorter and was completed towards the end of the 5th century. It is attributed to the commentators of the mishna who, imitating their elders, in turn felt the need to record their impressions. Upon completion of this compilation, the Jewish patriarchate of Palestine disappeared with Gamaliel V, the last descendant of Hillel.

It was not the same in Babylon. Since the great captivity, a large number of Jews had been keen not to abandon the banks of the Tigris and the Euphrates.

They lived there in a kind of separate society, in the midst of their religious traditions that they had faithfully preserved. For a long time, they kept at their head a "prince of exile," to whom the Persian kings successively recognized very extensive rights. There were flourishing schools in these regions. But in the 5th century, under Firouz, these schools were closed and the synagogues were destroyed.

The rabbis, believing that the time of final and total dispersion had come, wanted before the moment of the final separation, to leave an imperishable record of their teaching and that of their masters; they wrote the *ghemara*. It is ten or eleven times longer than the Mishna and was compiled by R. Aschi and his disciple Abina. This Babylonian Talmud, which consists of twelve folio volumes, has greater authority among the Jews than that of Jerusalem, perhaps because it is more impious, more iniquitous, and more explicit about the hatred that should be borne towards Christians.

The Talmud spread among the Jews with great rapidity and from the first centuries of our era it had the force of law in the Jewish communities.

The Fathers of the Church, Saint Justin, Origen, Saint Epiphanius already knew certain treatises of it. Saint Jerome says that this second law of the Jews "is full of fables and precepts so shameful that he would blush to say them." Saint Augustine condemns these oral traditions of the Jewish doctors and in particular their doctrine on polygamy: "By a gross error," he says, "and in order to authorize their morality as

"As early as the year 552, Justinian forbade the dissemination of this book throughout the empire. Since then, the kings and emperors have renewed these prescriptions; the popes and councils have on several occasions formally condemned these doctrines and have burned the book."

being of divine institution, they claim that God created two women for Adam: hence these endless genealogies and these fables already reprobated by Saint Paul."

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But nothing has worked. The Jews still hold their Talmud in great honor and continue to make it the rule of their conduct.

Rabbi Isaac Abnab teaches us that the foundation of the Jewish religion is the oral law, or the tradition of the Fathers, and not the law written by Moses: "It is in consideration of the oral law that God made an alliance with the Israelites, as it is written: *Quia juxta verba pango tecum foedus...* and these words are the treasures of the holy and blessed God."

"Abrabanel," says Rupert, "and the most esteemed masters of the synagogue have held the same opinion; they assert that the oral law contained in the Talmud has clarified the difficulties of the Mosaic law and filled in its gaps. In the book entitled *Horecoim*, it is established that all those who mock the masters of the synagogue, or say anything contrary to their teaching, will be thrown to the bottom of hell to be tormented there. The rabbis even teach, regarding the Talmud, that, if there is something in this book that is outside the natural order or that surpasses our intelligence, we must blame the weakness of human understanding, for, by meditating on it deeply, we notice that the Talmud contains only pure truth."

Consequently, "those who violate the precepts of the rabbis must be punished more severely than those who violate the law of Moses; the violator of the law of Moses may be absolved, *absolvi potest*; but the violator of the precepts of the rabbis must be punished with death: *morte moriatur*."

Since this is the case, everyone will understand how necessary it is to study this doctrine. It will be sufficiently known through the summary that follows.

To be continued...

NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

Welcome, dear Reader, to the eighth issue of *The Plough*.

In May, we honour the Blessed Virgin Mary as Queen of Man, and Queen of the Universe.

May our homelands, ravaged by Protestantism, liberalism, atheism and ultimately permanent revolution, take refuge in Our Lady's mediation. Her ever-watchful maternal care can't help but carry our burdens and worries to God.

In our desolate homelands, may the Blessed Virgin be honoured as The Mother of God, and as the spiritual Mother of all Christians.

In this issue, we have read of at least two

articles which relate the blessing of *action*:

firstly, we read of the Holy Father blessing plans for the Easter Rising, and secondly, of St Bernard blessing the Knights Templar. A Christian need not fear accusations of vainglory if he be zealous for justice, and seeks to apply his life, and perhaps even his death for a just cause in the Name of Christ. If he be pure-hearted, then God will preserve him in his course of *action*—God willing. He may deign to reward him eternally for his efforts.

Thank you for your loyal patronage, dear Reader, and may God bless you,

Editor of *The Plough*.



The Talmud contains all number of blasphemies against God.